

ATHENA

The CLEAR Framework

Guide + Worksheet



Get started with the **CLEAR Method**

The 30-second framework Athena clients use to delegate anything.

Most leaders think delegation fails because of the person doing the work.
In reality, it usually fails because **key information never gets communicated.**

When a delegated task misses the mark, it's almost always because **1 of 5** things was missing:

Context

The **who, what, and why** behind the ask

Limits

Boundaries for **what's acceptable and unacceptable**

Expectations

Establish **priority, timeline, and deliverable** for the outcome

Accountability

Decide **who takes ownership** of each part of the task

Review

Provide **high-quality feedback** at an established time or intervals

At Athena, we call it **CLEAR**. Once our clients start thinking about every task within this framework, their leadership efficiency skyrockets.

The **CLEAR** prompt (steal this)

Many
Athena clients
keep this on
a sticky note.

I need:

The task

Because:

Why it matters

By when:

Deadline

You own / I own:

Ownership

Do this / not that:

Parameters or constraints

Let's review:

When we'll check progress or finalize

Before vs. after **CLEAR**

Typical delegation

“Can you book my flight to LA next week?”

CLEAR
delegation

“I need to go to **LA Thursday** to meet a research team.
We only have **one working day** together,
so I need to land **before 9am PST**.”

Please **send flight options** by **4pm today**.
Once I approve, go ahead and book immediately.”

Same task, but the latter is far more **CLEAR**.

The **mistake** most leaders make

A CEO asks their EA for an investor briefing doc. The assistant delivers a polished summary, but **the CEO still has to rewrite it the night before.**

So what went wrong?

The EA never knew:

- × Who the investors were
- × What stage the relationship was in
- × Whether the goal was updating, persuading, or pitching



The issue here was
missing context

When limits **aren't clear**

A CMO asks
their EA:

*"Please handle floral arrangements for the board dinner.
Think elegant but not over-the-top."*

The EA hires a boutique florist and creates stunning arrangements. **Total cost: \$2,300.**
The CMO expected something closer to \$1,000, like the previous year.

Nothing went wrong except **one missing detail: budget.**
A simple limit would have **prevented the issue.**

The real payoff of **CLEAR**

When delegations are clear:

Work comes back right *the first time*.

Assistants make *better decisions independently*.

Leaders spend *less time* redoing work.

And over time, your assistant starts to think like you do.

Inside Athena, **CLEAR** is only the beginning.

Our **6-part Delegation Mastery** course teaches you **what, when, and how** to delegate any task so work comes back right the first time, every time.

And you get your time and life back.

Delegation Starter **Worksheet**

Identify **which tasks to delegate first** once you begin working with your **Executive Assistant** and begin thinking about each using the **CLEAR Method**.

Context

The **who, what, and why** behind the ask

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Instructions

List **15–20 professional tasks and 15–20 personal tasks** that drain your time.

For each task, estimate the **average time per week** it costs you (include cleanup, rework, and mental load if applicable).

Clarify **how you'd like to be involved** once delegated.

Identify the **first small step** toward delegation.

At the bottom of each section, **total your weekly time** to see the opportunity for leverage.

Section 1: Professional Tasks

#	Task	Avg. Time / Week (hrs)	CLEAR
1	Ex: Inbox triage and follow-ups	3.0	C: Leads and pitches require quick response to prevent deal loss L: EA does not communicate with VIP investors directly E: No email goes more than 2 business days unanswered A: EA independently handles internal comms & scheduling, and drafts responses for external contacts R: Review high-priority comms daily at 4pm for approval and send
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			

Section 1: Professional Tasks

#	Task	Avg. Time / Week (hrs)	CLEAR
11			
12			
13			
14			
15			
16			
17			
18			
19			
20			

Professional Time Total: _____ (fill in) hours per week

Section 2: Personal Tasks

#	Task	Avg. Time / Week (hrs)	CLEAR
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			
13			
14			
15			

Section 2: Personal Tasks

#	Task	Avg. Time / Week (hrs)	CLEAR
11			
12			
13			
14			
15			
16			
17			
18			
19			
20			

Professional Time Total: _____ (fill in) hours per week

Reflection

Total Professional + Personal Time: _____ (fill in) hours per week

If you reclaimed even a portion of this time, what would it allow you to focus on instead?

If reclaimed a portion of this time, it would allow me to focus on: (fill in)

100 Things You Didn't Know You Could Delegate

We asked leaders what they actually delegate to their Athena EAs.

Hint: *it's not just calendar + inbox.*

100 responsibilities delegated on average in the first year **100** responsibilities delegated on average in the first year **30%** of tasks are business/operational

STAGE 1:

Free your time
(and your mind)

Calendar
Inbox
Scheduling
Travel
Expenses

STAGE 2:

Systems
Master

Content calendars
KPI tracking
CRM management
Client onboarding
Event logistics

STAGE 3:

Operations
All Star

Process improvements
Dashboard reporting
Vendor management
Quarterly planning
Strategic research

STAGE 4:

Chief of Life
Unlocked

Process improvements
Dashboard reporting
Vendor management
Quarterly planning
Strategic research

A few of our most surprising delegations

Yes, these Athena EAs went *there*. There's no limit to what you can delegate.



Honorary marriage
counselor:

Sends and tracks **counseling homework** to both spouses.



Delivered for labor
and delivery:

Created a **first-time parent handbook** right down to the birth plan.



Etiquette expert:

Sends handwritten **thank you notes and invitations** on client's behalf.



A best friend for
man's best friend:

Managed **pet insurance, vet appointments, and medications** for a high-needs dog.